

TOSLINK was too overpowered for its time and by the time consumers reached the level of need, HDMI overshadowed it. Yet TOSLINK female ports are found in most computers, televisions and media receivers. Now even though they didn't get the same limelight as HDMI, there are a few things one can do with a TOSLINK cable lying around. A lot of audio systems from the time of TOSLINK don't support HDMI, yet perform brilliantly. TOSLINK can be used on such devices to deliver high-fidelity output. Another possible use is to kill ground loop by using TOSLINK for the culprit device. Because TOSLINK is either made of plastic or both glass and plastic, there is no conductivity to cause ground loops.

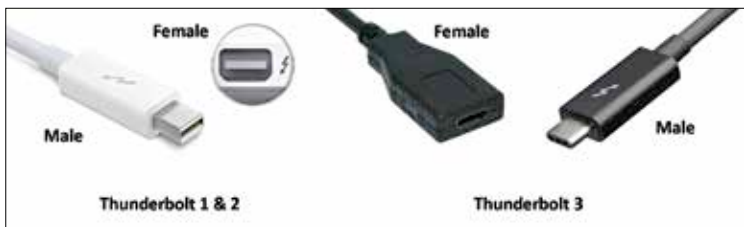


High Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) connectors

Another household name in media connectors is HDMI (High-Definition Multimedia Interface). It was founded by a consortium of Hitachi, Sanyo, Philips, Silicon Image, Sony, Technicolor SA and Toshiba in 2002 and later joined by more companies.

HDMI has become a standard in high quality media transfer, capable of carrying compressed and uncompressed video and audio signals. The large compatibility span and long list of strengths are the reasons for its popularity. It's even capable of transferring Dolby TrueHD and DTS-HD Master Audio formats. They are found on all modern computers, video projectors, digital televisions and audio systems.

In 2011, Apple registered Thunderbolt's trademark as an extremely powerful interface. It really was powerful and it still is. Intel, with whom



The Thunderbolt family